right, shooting arrows ferociously. Ayub Begchik's Moghūl Army did arrive as a helping aide to Babur, but ultimately it didn't come of use for, they immediately began working against Babur's interest. Against expectation, they began to plunder and unhorse Babur's men.

And to bring dismay to many those who call the dynasty of Babur 'Moghūls', the former has lamented and abused the latter. He has said, 'Not this once only, this is always the way with those ill-omened Moghūls! If they win, they grab at booty; if they lose, they unhorse and pilfer their own side.'

Babur's men drove away the Aūzbegs who attacked his front with several vigorous assaults, but those who had wheeled to the rear came up and rained arrows. Falling on them in this way, from the front, and the rear, Babur's men were made to hurry off.

Babur has said that this turning movement was one of the great merits of Aūzbeg fighting, and no battle of theirs was ever without it. He talks of another merit of theirs. They all, including the begs and retainers, rode and shouted as they charged in. They never scattered even till the time they rode out in a body.

Time was not right for Babur as he had thought it would be, looking at the astrological omen of eight stars. Around fifteen men were left with Babur. The Zarafshan River was close by. Babur made straight for it in the season when Zarafshan came down with floods. They rode right into it—man, and horse in the mail. The river was just fordable for halfway over, and after that, one had to swim. For more than an arrow's flight Babur's men mount in the mail. They made their horses swim, and that is how they got across. After getting out of the water, they cut off the horse armour. By thus crossing over to the north bank of the river, Babur and his men were temporarily free of the Shaybāni's clutches. Babur had known the Moghūls being wretched, the captors and pillagers of many of his friends so far in the battle. Ibrahim Tarkhān and many other excellent braves were unhorsed and killed by the Moghūls. The Elph. Codex of the *Baburnama* contains an interesting assertion made by Humayun in this context. It reads as below:[3]

> Where the Moghūl race angels, they would be bad;
>
> Written in gold, the name Moghūl would be bad;
>
> Pluck not an ear from the Moghūl's corn-land,
>
> What is sown with Moghūl seed will be bad.

Babur and his troops moved along the north bank of the Zarafshan River. They crossed it near Qulba and entered the town by the Shaikh Zada Gate, reaching the citadel in the middle of the afternoon.